# WARIS AHMAD FAIZI

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Google Scholar LinkedIn GitHub VT Experts

## EDUCATION

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|---|---|
| 2024– | Ph.D., Sociology, Virginia Tech<br>*Areas*: Economic Sociology; Digital Sociology; Labor, Work, and Organizations<br>*Methods*: Quantitative Methods; Computational Social Science<br>*Specialization areas*: Economic Sociology; Knowledge and Technology |
| 2026 | Graduate Certificate, Future Professoriate, Virginia Tech |
| Mar–Jul 2024 | Visiting Graduate Student, University of Tübingen, Germany (Erasmus+ and DAAD) |
| 2023 | M.A., Sociology, American University of Central Asia<br>Exchange semester (Erasmus+), Otto-von-Guericke University Magdeburg, Germany, 2022 |
| 2020 | M.A., Economics, OSCE Academy in Bishkek |
| 2015 | B.A., Economics, Kabul University |

## ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

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| 2026– | Graduate Research Assistant, Department of Sociology, Virginia Tech<br>Project Manager, GRASS Project (social dimensions of regenerative grazing; mixed-methods interviews and surveys), USDA-NRCS–funded Virginia Tech–West Virginia University collaboration; PI: Dr. Liesel Ritchie |
| Aug 2026 | Fellow, Summer Institute in Computational Social Science (SICSS), Stanford University |
| Jul–Aug 2026 | Teaching Assistant, ICPSR Summer Program in Quantitative Methods, University of Michigan<br>*Course*: Categorical Data Analysis: Models for Categorical, Ordinal, and Count Outcomes |
| May–Jun 2026 | Graduate Research Assistant, Department of Sociology, Virginia Tech |
| 2025–26 | Graduate Teaching Assistant, Department of Sociology, Virginia Tech |
| May–Jul 2025 | Graduate Research Assistant, Department of Sociology, Virginia Tech |
| 2024–25 | Graduate Teaching Assistant, Department of Sociology, Virginia Tech |

## RESEARCH AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

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| 2026– | Research Team Member, post-institute research project of the Summer Institute in Computational Social Science (SICSS), Stanford University: LLM-agent simulations of online polarization (built the ANES-derived agent population) |
| 2023–24 | Research Consultant, International Finance Corporation (IFC), World Bank Group<br>October 2023 – May 2024 |

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| 2022–23 | Research Intern, Office of the Vice President for Academic Affairs, American University of Central Asia |
| 2020–22 | Intern, Organization for Security and Co-operation in Europe (OSCE) Secretariat<br>September–October 2020; November 2021 – February 2022 (six months) |
| 2021 | Research Consultant, World Bank Project, Pearl Horizon Consulting |
| 2021 | Research Fellow, Central Asia Program, George Washington University |
| 2021 | Research Intern, Center for Research and Graduate Education (CRGE), Kazakh-German University (DKU) |

## AWARDS & HONORS

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| 2026 | Dean's Graduate Scholar, College of Liberal Arts and Human Sciences, Virginia Tech<br>Includes the CLAHS Fellowship Award |
| 2026 | Center for Humanities Graduate Student Fellowship, Virginia Tech |
| 2026 | Travel Fund Program (TFP) Award, Graduate and Professional Student Senate, Virginia Tech (for ASA 2026) |
| 2025 | Patricia and John Edwards Fellowship Award, Virginia Tech |
| 2024 | Erasmus+ Exchange Scholarship, University of Tübingen, Germany |
| 2023 | German Academic Exchange Service (DAAD) Scholarship, Germany |
| 2023 | Student Initiative Development Program Fund, Center for Civic Engagement, American University of Central Asia |
| 2022 | Erasmus+ Exchange Scholarship, Otto-von-Guericke University (OVGU), Germany |
| 2021 | Central Asia Program Research Fellowship, George Washington University |
| 2021 | M.A. Sociology Program Full Scholarship, American University of Central Asia |
| 2019 | M.A. Economics Program Full Scholarship, OSCE Academy in Bishkek |

## PUBLICATIONS

### Journal Articles

J2 Calasanti, T., **Faizi, W. A.** & King, N. *The Importance of Age Inequality for Intersectional Scholarship: The Case of the Workplace. Sociology Compass* **20**(10), e70263 (2026). Open access. https://doi.org/10.1111/soc4.70263

J1 **Faizi, W. A.**, Kim, D., Dogan, C., Park, S. & Kim, J. *Mapping Workforce Reskilling Urgency in the Age of AI: Occupational and Geographic Patterns across the United States. Telematics and Informatics* **109**, 102445 (2026). https://doi.org/10.1016/j.tele.2026.102445

### Revise and Resubmit

RR1 **Faizi, W. A.** *From Perk to Norm: The Diffusion of Remote Work and the Divergence of Its Satisfaction and Pay.* Revise and resubmit at *Social Currents*; revised manuscript under review. 2026.

### Manuscripts under Review

R2 Roos, J. M., **Faizi, W. A.** & Lin, S.-H. *Confidence in Science and US Political Institutions, 2010–2024: Four Distinct Patterns of Polarization, or the 'Politicization Pitchfork'*. Under review at *Social Science Research*. 2026.

R1 **Faizi, W. A.** *Autonomy, Precarity, and Stratified Returns Across Employment Sectors.* Under review at *Sociological Forum*. 2026.

### Manuscripts in Preparation

M2 **Faizi, W. A.** *Pricing Care Labor: The Devaluation of Bodywork and the Intersectional Division of Reproductive Labor.* In preparation. 2026.

M1 **Faizi, W. A.** *Social Capital and the Timing of Corporate Elite Mobility.* Ready for submission to *Research in Social Stratification and Mobility*. 2026.

### Works in Progress

W5 **Faizi, W. A.** *Neoliberal Doxa across the World-System: Economic Beliefs in the Global North and South.*

W4 **Faizi, W. A.** *Not All Moves Are Equal: How Employment and Capital Composition Shape Residential Mobility Strategies.*

W3 **Faizi, W. A.** *The Moral Economies of Influencer Culture: Visibility, Value, and Intersectional Precarity.*

W2 **Faizi, W. A.** *Divergent Value Trajectories: Cultural and Economic Liberalization in the United States, 2004–2024.*

W1 Roos, J. M., **Faizi, W. A.** & Lin, S.-H. *Item Level Bias in the NSF-sponsored Science Knowledge Scale, 2006–2024.*

### Research Reports

P1 **Faizi, W. A.** *The Future of the CASA-1000 Electric Megaproject in the Context of the New Afghanistan.* Central Asia Program, George Washington University (2021). centralasiaprogram.org/archive/central-asia-research-paper/

## CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

C14 **Faizi, W. A.** *From Perk to Norm: The Diffusion of Remote Work and the Divergence of Its Satisfaction and Pay.* Population Association of America (PAA), 2027 Annual Meeting (Seattle, WA, USA). Apr. 2027.

C13 **Faizi, W. A.** *Not All Moves Are Equal: How Employment and Capital Composition Shape Residential Mobility Strategies.* Association for Humanist Sociology (AHS), 50th Annual Meeting (New Brunswick, NJ, USA). Oct. 2026.

C12 **Faizi, W. A.** *Neoliberal Doxa across the World-System: Economic Beliefs in the Global North and South.* Mid-South Sociological Association (MSSA), 52nd Annual Conference (Huntsville, AL, USA). Oct. 2026.

C11 **Faizi, W. A.** *Social Capital and the Timing of Corporate Elite Mobility.* American Sociological Association (ASA), 121st Annual Meeting (New York, NY, USA). Aug. 2026.

C10 **Faizi, W. A.** *Pricing Care Labor: The Devaluation of Bodywork and the Intersectional Division of Reproductive Labor.* Society for the Study of Social Problems (SSSP), 76th Annual Meeting (New York, NY, USA). Aug. 2026.

C9 **Faizi, W. A.** *Social Capital and the Geography of Opportunity: Economic Connectedness, Bias, and Mobility in the United States.* Southern Sociological Society (SSS) Annual Meeting (Jacksonville, FL, USA). Apr. 2026.

C8 **Faizi, W. A.** *Divergent Value Trajectories: Cultural and Economic Liberalization in the United States, 2004–2024.* 42nd Annual GPSS Research Symposium and Exposition, Virginia Tech (Blacksburg, VA, USA). Mar. 2026.

C7 **Faizi, W. A.** *The Moral Economies of Influencer Culture: Visibility, Value, and Intersectional Precarity.* Eastern Sociological Society (ESS), 96th Annual Meeting (Washington, DC, USA). Mar. 2026.

C6 **Faizi, W. A.** *Redistribution Gap: Class, Race and Political Ideology in Shaping Attitudes Toward Inequality.* Association for Humanist Sociology (AHS), 49th Annual Meeting (Columbus, OH, USA). Nov. 2025.

C5 **Faizi, W. A.** *Economic Precarity, Quality of Work Life, and Social Trust: An Empirical Study of the U.S. Workforce (2004–2024).* Society for the Study of Social Problems (SSSP) Annual Meeting (Chicago, IL, USA). Aug. 2025.

C4 **Faizi, W. A.** *Public, Private, or Personal: Comparative Impacts of Government, Private, and Self-Employment on Job and Financial Satisfaction in the United States.* Canadian Association for Work and Labour Studies (CAWLS) (Hamilton, ON, Canada). May 2025.

C3 **Faizi, W. A.** *Digital Transformation and Work Paradigm's Shift: Remote Work's Impact on Social Networks and Integration, Well-being, and Economic Stability in the United States.* Southern Sociological Society (SSS) Annual Meeting (Charlotte, NC, USA). Apr. 2025.

C2 **Faizi, W. A.** *Efficacy of Human Skills Development as a Source of Regional Competitive Advantage and Economic Development in Afghanistan.* South Asian Economics Students' Meet (SAESM) (Colombo, Sri Lanka). Apr. 2016.

C1 **Faizi, W. A.** *Afghan Carpets' Export Situation: Challenges and Opportunities.* South Asian Economics Students' Meet (SAESM) (Thimphu, Bhutan). Dec. 2014.

## MEDIA COVERAGE

2026 Research featured in *VT News*, "How urgently do AI-exposed jobs need retraining?" (Sept. 17, 2026), on the *Telematics and Informatics* reskilling-urgency study
https://news.vt.edu/articles/2026/09/cnre-rui.html

2026 Coverage republished by *Technology.org* (Sept. 28, 2026)
https://www.technology.org/2026/09/28/how-urgently-do-ai-exposed-jobs-need-retraining/

## TEACHING

**ICPSR Summer Program in Quantitative Methods, University of Michigan**

2026 Teaching Assistant, Categorical Data Analysis: Models for Categorical, Ordinal, and Count Outcomes, Graduate

**Virginia Tech**

2024–26 Graduate Teaching Assistant, SOC 1004: Introductory Sociology, Undergraduate

2024–26 Graduate Teaching Assistant, SOC 3204: Social Research Methods, Undergraduate

2024–26 Graduate Teaching Assistant, AFST 1814: Introduction to African Studies, Undergraduate

2024–26 Graduate Teaching Assistant, AFST 4354: Topics in Africana Studies, Undergraduate

**Prior Teaching Appointments**

2019–21 Lecturer / Instructor, Gawharshad University

2019–21 Lecturer / Instructor, Tolo-e-Aftab Institute of Higher Education

2016–21 Lecturer / Instructor, Sayed Jamaluddin Afghan Institute of Higher Education

2016–18 Lecturer / Instructor, Fanoos Institute of Higher Education

**Pedagogical Training**

2025–26 Future Professoriate / Global Perspectives Program (GPP), Virginia Tech

- Preparing Future Professoriate (3 credits), Fall 2025
- Contemporary Pedagogy (3 credits), Spring 2026
- Higher Education 360 (3 credits), Spring 2026

## SERVICE

2026 Manuscript Reviewer, *Social Indicators Research*

Jan–Jun 2026 Graduate Research Fellow, Center for Humanities (CfH), Virginia Tech

2023 Career Development Mentor / Trainer, American University of Central Asia

## PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

Current American Sociological Association (ASA); Southern Sociological Society (SSS); Eastern Sociological Society (ESS); Society for the Study of Social Problems (SSSP); Association for Humanist Sociology (AHS); Pacific Sociological Association (PSA); Mid-South Sociological Association (MSSA)

Affiliations Stanford Center on Poverty and Inequality (CPI), Stanford University; Center for Future Work Places and Practices (CFWPP), Virginia Tech; Dataism Laboratory for Quantitative Finance (DLQF), Virginia Tech; Center for Humanities (CfH), Virginia Tech

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

Statistical R, Python, Stata, SPSS, JMP

Other SQL and database management, ArcGIS Online, LaTeX (Overleaf), high-performance computing (Virginia Tech ARC)

## ADVANCED METHODS TRAINING

Summer 2026 ICPSR Summer Program in Quantitative Methods, Inter-university Consortium for Political and Social Research, University of Michigan

- Categorical Data Analysis: Models for Categorical, Ordinal, and Count Outcomes
- Causal Inference for the Social Sciences II
- Network Analysis II: Advanced Topics
- Structural Equation Models with Latent Variables

## PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT & TRAINING

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| 2026 | Pursuing a Postdoc Proactively series, Office of Postdoctoral Affairs, Virginia Tech (Oct.–Nov. 2026) |
| 2026 | Social Network Analysis, University of California, Davis (Coursera) |
| 2026 | Causal Inference, Columbia University (Coursera) |
| 2026 | Social and Economic Networks: Models and Analysis, Stanford University (Coursera) |
| 2026 | Narrative Economics, Yale University (Coursera) |
| 2026 | Best Practices for Mentorship in Teaching, Virginia Tech |
| 2026 | Introduction to Geospatial Mapping and ArcGIS Online, Virginia Tech |
| 2026 | Manage Your Scholarly Identity Challenge Course, Virginia Tech |
| 2026 | Connect to ARC Systems with VSCode; Advanced Research Computing Roadmap, Virginia Tech |
| 2026 | The Joyful Journey: Graduate Student and Postdoctoral Scholar Professional Development Series, CIRTL |
| 2025 | Day for Data, AI & Analytics Symposium, Center for the Arts, Virginia Tech |
| 2025 | Datapalooza 2025: Truth and Accountability in the Age of AI, University of Virginia School of Data Science |
| 2025 | Preparing for the Academic Job Market Workshop Series, University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill |
| 2025 | Summer Institute for Undergraduate Education, Virginia Tech |
| 2025 | Introduction to LaTeX with Overleaf; Introduction to Database Management and SQL, Virginia Tech |
| 2024 | Social & Behavioral Research, CITI Basic Course |
| 2024 | Graduate Teaching Assistant (GTA) Workshop Series, Virginia Tech |
| 2021–25 | Courses in Python and R, LinkedIn Learning and DataCamp |

## REFERENCES

**Toni Calasanti**, Ph.D.
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